STAAR Bootcamp: staar-case-files

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — Quick-Start Overview

Welcome, Detective!

You've downloaded **STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery** — a detective/mystery-themed STAAR prep week where students solve a week-long case. Each day reveals a new clue, and by Friday, they've cracked the case and mastered their STAAR skills.

📦 What's in This Package

File	What It Is
LESSON-PLANS.md	5-day mystery case lesson plans
ACTIVITIES.md	10+ detective-themed activities and review games
DECORATIONS.md	Classroom case file setup + hallway crime scene tape
STUDENT-MATERIALS.md	Detective notebooks, clue cards, badges, certificates
PARENT-LETTER.md	Family communication template

🔎 The Theme at a Glance

- **Students are:** Detectives investigating "The Case of STAAR Mastery"
- **Teacher is:** Chief Detective / Lead Investigator
- **Each day:** A new clue is revealed

- **Completing work earns:** Evidence stamps in their detective notebook
- **STAAR test is:** Cracking the case
- **Classroom becomes:** Detective Agency HQ

📅 Week Overview

Day	Case File	Focus
Monday	**Clue #1: The Missing Main Idea**	Reading/ELA
Tuesday	**Clue #2: The Numbers Don't Add Up**	Math
Wednesday	**Clue #3: The Scientific Evidence**	Science/SS
Thursday	**Clue #4: The Full Investigation**	Mixed practice test
Friday	**Clue #5: Case Closed!**	Strategies, celebration

🔎 The Mystery (Week-Long Arc)

Create a simple mystery that unfolds over the week. Example:

> ***"The Case of the Missing STAAR Scores"*** *Someone has stolen the class's future STAAR scores! Each day, students uncover a clue by mastering skills. On Friday, they assemble all 5 clues to reveal the "thief" — it was DOUBT all along. The solution? Confidence and preparation!*

Reveal one clue each day (written on a card, posted on the "Evidence Board"). By Friday, students piece them together.

⏰ Quick Setup

1. Print detective badges and notebooks

2. Set up door sign (“Detective Agency HQ”) and evidence board
3. Prepare 5 daily clue cards
4. Send parent letter
5. Channel your inner Sherlock! 🔍

The game is afoot, Detective! 🔍

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — 5-Day Lesson Plans

> ***Chief Detective’s Case File***

Daily Schedule Template

Time Block	Duration	Activity
Case Briefing	10 min	Daily clue reveal, motivation
Investigation 1	45 min	Guided review
Coffee Break	5 min	Brain break
Investigation 2	40 min	Independent evidence gathering (practice)
Case Notes	10 min	Review, update detective notebooks

🔍 The Week-Long Mystery

“The Case of the Missing STAAR Scores”

Setup: On Monday, announce that "someone" has stolen the class's confidence/STAAR readiness. Each day, students earn a clue by completing their work. Friday, they assemble all 5 clues.

Clue Cards (prepare in advance): 1. Monday: "The thief strikes when students don't READ carefully." 2. Tuesday: "The thief hides in SKIPPED STEPS and rushed calculations." 3. Wednesday: "The thief feeds on GAPS IN KNOWLEDGE." 4. Thursday: "The thief is strongest when students PANIC under pressure." 5. Friday: "The thief's name is… DOUBT! And YOU have defeated it with PREPARATION!"

Post each clue on the "Evidence Board" at the end of each day.

🔍 MONDAY — Clue #1: The Missing Main Idea

Theme: "A good detective reads everything carefully. Today we investigate texts like crime scenes — every detail matters."

Case Briefing (10 min)

> *"Detectives! I'm Chief Detective [Name], and we have a case. Someone — or something — is threatening our STAAR success. This week, we investigate. We gather clues. And on Friday, we crack the case. But we need SHARP minds. Today's investigation: reading. A detective who can't read carefully can't solve anything. Every passage is a crime scene. Every question is a lead. Let's investigate!"*

- Hand out **Detective Badges** and **Detective Notebooks**
- Show the **Evidence Board** (empty — "We need clues!")
- Explain: complete today's work = earn Clue #1

Investigation 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) "Witness Statements" Warm-Up** — 5 quick reading questions. "These witnesses saw something. What can we learn from their statements?"

2. **(20 min) "Crime Scene Analysis"** — Teacher models close reading of a STAAR passage. "A detective examines every piece of evidence. Watch how I interrogate this text…" Demonstrate annotation as "evidence collection."
3. **(15 min) "Partner Investigation"** — Pairs work a passage together, taking turns being "lead detective" and "partner." Must cite evidence for every answer.

Coffee Break (5 min)

- "Suspect Lineup" — Teacher shows 5 vocabulary words. Students must "identify the suspect" — which word matches the definition given? Quick, active, fun.

Investigation 2 (40 min)

"Case File #1" — Reading Packet - STAAR-format questions framed as "evidence" - "Examine the evidence carefully. Your answers will bring us closer to solving the case." - Early finishers: "Cold Case" bonus challenge

Differentiation: - **Struggling:** "Junior Detective" version — guided evidence markers, simpler language - **Advanced:** "Senior Detective" — complex texts, analytical questions - **ELL:** Visual evidence cards, bilingual vocabulary

Case Notes (10 min)

- Review tough questions: "The evidence was tricky here, but look…"
- **Detective's Rule #1:** Post on Evidence Board: "Always find evidence in the text before making an accusation (choosing an answer)."
- Students who completed the case file earn **Clue #1** — post it on the Evidence Board!
- Detective notebooks: students record today's key learning

🔍 TUESDAY — Clue #2: The Numbers Don't Add Up

Theme: "Something doesn't add up — literally. Today we crunch the numbers and find the mathematical truth."

Case Briefing (10 min)

> *"Detectives, Clue #1 told us the thief strikes when we don't read carefully. Today we follow the money — the NUMBERS. In every great investigation, the numbers tell the story. If the numbers don't add up, you've found a lie. Today, we make sure OUR numbers add up perfectly."*

Investigation 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) "Number Interrogation"** — Timed computation warm-up. "Interrogate these numbers! Get answers fast!"
2. **(20 min) "Following the Paper Trail"** — Teacher models multi-step word problems as "following the money trail." Show every step. "If we skip a step, we lose the trail!"
3. **(15 min) "Good Cop/Bad Cop"** — Partners alternate: one solves (good cop — careful, methodical), one challenges (bad cop — "Are you SURE? Check that step!"). Switch roles.

Coffee Break (5 min)

- "True or False Interrogation" — 5 math statements, students stand for true, sit for false.

Investigation 2 (40 min)

"Case File #2" — Math Packet - STAAR-format math questions - "The numbers in this case don't add up. Fix them."

Case Notes (10 min)

- **Detective's Rule #2:** "Show ALL your work. Evidence that can't be seen can't be used."
- Earn **Clue #2** — add to Evidence Board
- Update detective notebooks

🔍 WEDNESDAY — Clue #3: The Scientific Evidence

Theme: "A great detective uses science and knowledge of the world. Today we examine the scientific and historical evidence."

Case Briefing (10 min)

> *"Two clues down, three to go. Today we examine the SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE. The best detectives in the world use forensic science. They know history. They understand how the world works. Today, science and social studies are our forensic tools."*

Investigation 1 (45 min)

1. **(10 min) "Forensic Lab" Warm-Up** — 5 science/SS questions. "Quick forensic analysis!"
2. **(20 min) "Evidence Stations"** — 4 stations, each a different "lab":
   - Forensic Lab A: Science concepts
   - Forensic Lab B: Social studies facts
   - Forensic Lab C: Vocabulary analysis
   - Forensic Lab D: Mixed mystery questions Groups rotate every 5 min.
3. **(15 min) "Suspect Profile"** — Students create a "profile" of their weakest topic: what it is, why it's hard, how to approach it. "Know your suspect!"

Coffee Break (5 min)

- "Whodunit?" — Teacher reads a short, silly mystery. Students guess the answer. Pure fun.

Investigation 2 (40 min)

"Case File #3" — Science/SS Packet (shorter — 10-12 questions) - Remaining time: **"Interrogation Room" Review Game** — Teacher vs. Class. Teacher asks increasingly

hard questions. Class works together to answer. If they stump the teacher (ask a question teacher "can't" answer), bonus points!

Case Notes (10 min)

- **Detective's Rule #3:** "When you don't know, eliminate what you DO know is wrong. Narrow the suspects!"
- Earn **Clue #3** — Evidence Board growing!
- Midweek treat 🎉

🔍 THURSDAY — Clue #4: The Full Investigation

Theme: "Time for a full investigation. Every skill, every clue, all at once."

Case Briefing (10 min)

> *"Detectives, we're close to cracking this case. Today is the full investigation — every skill, every subject, just like the real STAAR. Treat this like the real deal. Stay focused. Stay sharp. A sloppy investigation misses the truth."*

Investigation 1 (45 min)

"Full Investigation" — Mini Practice Test - 20-30 mixed STAAR-format questions - Test conditions: silent, independent, timed

Coffee Break (5 min)

- Quiet stretch.

Investigation 2 (40 min)

1. **(15 min)** Review answers — "Let's review the investigation for errors"
2. **(10 min)** Self-assessment: strengths, weak areas
3. **(15 min)** Small group "special task forces" — grouped by need

Case Notes (10 min)

- **Detective's Rule #4:** "Stay calm under pressure. A panicked detective makes mistakes."
- Earn **Clue #4**
- "Tomorrow we crack the case."

🔍 FRIDAY — Clue #5: Case Closed! 🎉

Theme: "All the clues are in. Time to solve the mystery and celebrate."

Case Briefing (10 min)

> *"Detectives. Five days of investigation. Four clues on the board. Today… we get the FINAL CLUE and CRACK THE CASE. But first — a few final tools for your detective kit."*

Investigation 1 (45 min)

1. **(15 min) "Detective's Toolkit"** — Review top 10 test-taking strategies
2. **(15 min) "Cold Case Review"** — Quick game reviewing commonly missed question types
3. **(15 min) "The Big Reveal"** — Reveal Clue #5! Read all 5 clues together. "The thief was… DOUBT! And you've DEFEATED it through preparation and hard work!"

Coffee Break (5 min)

Investigation 2: Case Closed Celebration (40 min)

1. **(10 min)** "Closing Statement" — Students write their final case notes / letter to themselves
2. **(10 min) "Case Closed" Certificate Ceremony**
3. **(10 min)** Students sign each other's detective notebooks

4. **(10 min)** Celebration — music, treats, photos

Final Case Notes

- **Detective's Rule #5:** "The truth was inside you all along. Trust your training."
- All 5 clues earned = "Master Detective" status
- "CASE CLOSED. You're STAAR ready." 🔍

Elementary, my dear students. You've solved it. 🔍

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — Themed Activities

> *10 detective-themed activities with 3 review games.*

🎮 REVIEW GAMES

1. Interrogation Room (Whole Class)

Type: Class game | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Any subject review

How to Play: - Teacher reads a question. The question is the "suspect." - Students write their answer on whiteboards — this is their "accusation" - Reveal correct answer. Students who got it right "solved the case" for that round - Track: How many cases did the class solve out of 15? - Dramatic narration: "The suspect claims the answer is B. Detective Johnson says C. Let's check the evidence… C IS CORRECT! Case solved!"

Materials: Questions, whiteboards, markers

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2. Escape the Crime Scene (Escape Room)

Type: Small groups (3-4) | **Time:** 30 min | **Best for:** Mixed review

Setup: - 4-5 sealed envelopes ("evidence bags") per group - Each contains a question set; correct answers reveal a code - Final code unlocks the case (prize envelope)

How to Play: 1. Groups open Evidence Bag 1, solve questions, derive code 2. Bring code to Chief Detective (teacher) for verification 3. If correct, get Evidence Bag 2. If wrong, try again. 4. First group to crack all codes "escapes the crime scene"

Materials: Envelopes, question sets, codes, prize envelope

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3. Whodunit? Speed Round

Type: Individual competitive | **Time:** 15 min | **Best for:** Vocabulary, facts, computation

How to Play: - Project questions one at a time with 10-second timer - Students write answers on whiteboards - Correct = 1 point. Wrong = 0. - Every 5 questions: a "Whodunit?" bonus round — teacher reads a riddle/brain teaser worth 3 points - Highest score = "Sherlock of the Day"

Materials: Projected questions, whiteboards, timer

👤 INDIVIDUAL ACTIVITIES

4. Detective Notebook (Daily Journal)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 10 min daily | **Best for:** Reflection, writing

Instructions: Students write daily entries in their Detective Notebook: - **Monday:** "Evidence collected today: [what I learned]. Primary suspect (hardest topic): [topic]. Lead to follow: [what to study]." - **Tuesday:** "Numbers analysis: [math reflection]. The numbers reveal: [insight]." - **Wednesday:** "Forensic report: [science/SS reflection]. Evidence supports: [key fact]." - **Thursday:** "Investigation summary: My strongest evidence is [skill]. Weakest lead: [skill]." - **Friday:** "Closing statement: I'm ready to crack the STAAR because [reason]."

Materials: Detective Notebook (stapled pages with cover)

5. Suspect Profile (Weakness Analysis)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 15 min | **Best for:** Metacognition

Instructions: Students create a "Suspect Profile" for their hardest test topic: - **Suspect Name:** (e.g., "Fractions" or "Author's Purpose") - **Last Seen:** (when did this topic give you trouble?) - **Known Tactics:** (what makes this topic confusing?) - **How to Apprehend:** (specific strategies to master it) - Sketch of the "suspect" (fun drawing)

Post on a "Most Wanted Wall" in the classroom.

Materials: Template or blank paper, markers

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6. Clue Card Collection (Flashcard Study)

Type: Individual | **Time:** 15 min to create, 5 min/day to use

Instructions: Students create "Clue Cards" — flashcards styled as evidence: - Front: "EVIDENCE #[number]" — term or concept - Back: "FINDINGS:" — definition, example, memory trick - Cards stored in an "Evidence Bag" (ziplock or envelope) - Daily: 5 minutes of self-quizzing with clue cards

Materials: Index cards, markers, ziplock bags/envelopes

👥 PARTNER ACTIVITIES

7. Good Cop / Bad Cop (Partner Problem Solving)

Type: Partner | **Time:** 20 min | **Best for:** Math, reading comprehension

Instructions: - Good Cop = solves carefully, shows all work, explains thinking - Bad Cop = challenges every step: "Prove it!" "Are you sure?" "Check that!" - Switch roles every 3 problems - Both must sign off on every answer

Materials: Problem set, paper, pencils

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8. Witness Interview (Partner Quiz)

Type: Partner | **Time:** 15-20 min | **Best for:** Any subject

Instructions: Each student creates 5 "interview questions" (review questions) about the day's topic. Then they "interview" their partner: - Ask the question - Partner answers - If correct: "Witness is reliable!" ✓ - If incorrect: "Witness needs more evidence." Review together. - Switch roles

Materials: Paper, pencils

👥👥 GROUP ACTIVITIES

9. Crime Lab Stations (Rotation)

Type: Groups of 4-5 | **Time:** 30 min | **Best for:** Multi-topic review

Stations: - 🔬 **DNA Lab** — Reading comprehension (analyzing the "genetic code" of a passage) - 🔢 **Numbers Lab** — Math computation and word problems - 🧪 **Forensics Lab** — Science questions - 🗂️ **Cold Case Files** — Social studies / mixed review

Groups rotate every 7 minutes. Record findings on "Lab Report" sheet.

Materials: Station question sets, lab report sheets, timer

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10. Case Board Assembly (Collaborative Study Guide)

Type: Groups of 3-4 | **Time:** 25 min | **Best for:** End-of-week synthesis

Instructions: Each group creates a "case board" (poster) for one topic — like a detective's evidence wall: - Key terms connected with string/lines (drawn) - "Evidence" (examples and facts) posted as sticky notes or written cards - "Red herrings" identified (common wrong answers/mistakes) - "Conclusion" (summary of the topic)

Post all case boards. Students do a "gallery walk" to review.

Materials: Poster board or butcher paper, markers, sticky notes

📝 Activity Matrix

Activity	Best Day	Duration	Type
Interrogation Room	Wed or Fri	20 min	Class game
Escape the Crime Scene	Thu or Fri	30 min	Group game
Whodunit? Speed Round	Any (warm-up)	15 min	Class game
Detective Notebook	Daily	10 min	Individual
Suspect Profile	Mon or Wed	15 min	Individual
Clue Card Collection	Mon (create), daily (use)	15+5/day	Individual
Good Cop / Bad Cop	Tue	20 min	Partner
Witness Interview	Wed or Thu	15-20 min	Partner
Crime Lab Stations	Wed	30 min	Group rotation
Case Board Assembly	Thu or Fri	25 min	Group

Every detail matters. Every clue counts. Solve it. 🔍

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — Student Materials

📋 Daily Overview

Day	Handouts	Rewards
Monday	Detective Badge, Detective Notebook, Case File #1	Clue #1 revealed
Tuesday	Case File #2	Clue #2 revealed
Wednesday	Case File #3, Suspect Profile template	Clue #3 + treat
Thursday	Full Investigation test, Self-Assessment	Clue #4 revealed
Friday	Closing Statement letter, notebook signing page	Clue #5 + Case Closed Certificate

Detective Badge

Design: - Size: 3” x 4” (4 per page), shield/badge shape - Header: “STAAR DETECTIVE AGENCY” - **Detective:** [Student Name] - **Badge #:** [Number] - **Rank:** Junior Detective (upgraded to “Master Detective” on Friday) - **Specialty:** [Student’s best subject] - Space for self-portrait or small photo - “Licensed to Investigate”

Detective Notebook

Description: A stapled booklet for the entire week. 7 pages + cover.

Cover: - “TOP SECRET — DETECTIVE NOTEBOOK” - “Property of Detective [Name]” - “Case: #STAAR — Mission to Mastery” - “Classification: CONFIDENTIAL” - Space for badge number

Pages: 1. **Case Overview** — Students write: “The case,” “My team,” “My goal for this week” 2-6. **Daily Case Notes** (one per day Mon-Fri) — Date, daily prompt, key findings, strategy learned 7. **Closing Statement** — Final reflection + space for classmate signatures on Friday

📁 Daily Case Files (Packets)

Cover format: - "📁 CASE FILE #[Number] — [Case Name]" - "CLASSIFIED — For Detective Eyes Only" - "Detective: _____ Badge #: _____ Date: _____" - "Assignment: Examine the following evidence and determine the correct answers." - STAAR-format questions inside (teacher provides) - Back page: "Investigation Notes — Evidence that supports my answers: _____ Leads to follow up: _____"

🔎 Clue Cards

Description: 5 pre-made cards (teacher prepares) revealed one per day.

Design: - Size: 5" x 7" - Header: "🔍 CLUE #[Number]" - Large text with the clue message - Footer: "Add to Evidence Board" - Slightly aged/worn look (crumple slightly, tea-stain edges if feeling crafty)

The 5 clues: 1. "The thief strikes when students don't READ carefully." 2. "The thief hides in SKIPPED STEPS and rushed calculations." 3. "The thief feeds on GAPS IN KNOWLEDGE." 4. "The thief is strongest when students PANIC under pressure." 5. "The thief's name is... DOUBT! And YOU have defeated it with PREPARATION!"

🎯 Suspect Profile Template

Description: Wednesday activity — students "profile" their hardest academic topic.

Design: - Title: "SUSPECT PROFILE" - **Suspect Name:** _____ (topic name) - **Aliases:** _____ (related terms) - **Last Seen:** _____ (when did this topic trip you up?) - **Known Tactics:** _____ (what makes this confusing?) - **Weakness:** _____ (strategy to defeat it) - **WANTED FOR:** Causing confusion on tests - Large box: "Suspect Sketch" (student draws a funny character) - "REWARD: STAAR success!"

🏆 Case Closed Certificate

Design: - 8.5x11 landscape - Header: Magnifying glass + “STAAR DETECTIVE AGENCY” - Title: “CASE CLOSED CERTIFICATE” - “This certifies that **Detective [Name]** has successfully solved Case #STAAR by collecting all evidence, investigating all subjects, and demonstrating mastery. This detective has proven that DOUBT is no match for PREPARATION.” - “Chief Detective: [Teacher Name]” - “Case Closed: [Date]” - Border: magnifying glasses, footprints, noir-style design

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✉️ Closing Statement (Friday Letter)

Template: - “CLOSING STATEMENT — Case #STAAR” - “I, Detective [Name], submit the following findings:” - “The evidence shows I am strong in: _____” - “My investigation revealed I should review: _____” - “My strategy for test day: _____” - “I am confident because: _____” - “Case status: READY TO CLOSE. ✓” - Signed and dated

Sealed in envelope, returned on STAAR day.

📊 Printing Summary

Material	Per Student	For 25 Students
Detective Badge	0.25 pages	7 pages
Detective Notebook	4 pages (double-sided)	100 pages
Case Files (5 days)	~3-5/day	75-125 pages
Clue Cards	shared (1 set)	5 cards
Suspect Profile	1 page	25 pages
Certificate	1 page	25 pages
Closing Statement	1 page	25 pages
TOTAL (ex. case files)		**~185 pages + case files**

Equip your detectives. The truth is in the evidence. 🔍

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — Decoration Guide

> *Moody, mysterious, and surprisingly easy to set up.*

🏠 CLASSROOM: Detective Agency HQ

Door Sign

- **"DETECTIVE AGENCY HQ — Case #STAAR — INVESTIGATORS ONLY"**
- Magnifying glass graphic
- Black and white color scheme for "noir" feel
- Print on 11x17 or 2 pages taped together

Evidence Board (CENTERPIECE)

- Bulletin board or large poster dedicated to the week's mystery
- Title: "EVIDENCE BOARD — Case #STAAR"
- Start Monday with a "?" in the center
- Add one clue card each day
- Connect clues with yarn or drawn lines
- By Friday: all 5 clues plus the solution revealed
- **This is the most engaging decoration.** Students check it daily.
- **Cost:** $0-2 (use existing bulletin board + yarn)

Wall Decorations

Detective's Rules

- Post each day's rule as you reveal it (5 total by Friday)
- Write on paper styled as "case notes" (slightly crumpled for effect)

Most Wanted Wall

- Space for students' "Suspect Profiles" (Wednesday activity)
- Title: "MOST WANTED — Academic Suspects at Large"

Motivational Posters

- "The evidence is clear: you're STAAR ready."
- "Great detectives don't guess — they FIND EVIDENCE."
- "The case isn't closed until you CHECK YOUR WORK."
- "Elementary, my dear student — you've GOT this!"

Desk Name Tags

- **"Detective [Name]"**
- Badge/shield graphic
- "Badge #: [student number]"
- "Specialty: [best subject]"

🏫 HALLWAY: Crime Scene

Hallway Banner

- **"⚠️ STAAR TESTING ZONE — DO NOT CROSS ⚠️"**
- Styled like crime scene tape: yellow background, black text
- Use yellow butcher paper or yellow streamer strips with black marker
- Hang across hallway entrance or above classroom door
- **Cost:** $1-3

Footprint Trail

- Cut footprint shapes from black construction paper
- Tape to hallway floor leading from entrance to classroom
- Optional: add magnifying glass cutouts scattered among the footprints
- **Cost:** $1-2 for construction paper

Classroom Door "Crime Scene"

- Yellow streamer strips across the door (like caution tape)
- Text on strips: "STAAR TESTING ZONE" or "CASE IN PROGRESS"
- Magnifying glass cutout on the door
- **Cost:** $1 for yellow streamers

🖨️ Printable Elements

Printable	Description	Size
Door Sign	"Detective Agency HQ — Investigators Only" noir style	11x17
Evidence Board header	"EVIDENCE BOARD — Case #STAAR"	8.5x11
Clue Cards	5 cards with daily clues (pre-written)	5x7
Crime Scene Banner	Yellow "DO NOT CROSS — STAAR TESTING ZONE" tape strips	Banner
Detective Badges	Shield shape with "Detective [Name], Badge #"	3x4 (4/page)
Desk Name Tags	"Detective [Name]" with badge graphic	Tent fold
Footprint Cutouts	Shoe prints for hallway trail	4x6
Magnifying Glass Cutouts	Large magnifying glass shapes for door/hallway	6-8 inch
Motivational Posters	4 detective-themed quotes	8.5x11

Printable	Description	Size
Case Closed Certificate	“This certifies [Name] has solved Case #STAAR…”	8.5x11 landscape

💰 Total Budget

Item	Cost
Yellow streamers (crime tape)	$1
Black construction paper (footprints)	$1
Poster board (evidence board)	$1
Yarn (evidence board connections)	$1
Cardstock (badges, name tags)	$1
TOTAL	**$3-7**

One of the cheapest themes — the mystery and drama do all the work!

The scene is set. The case awaits. 🔍

🔍 STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery — Parent Letter

English Version

[School Letterhead]

[Date]

Dear Families,

Next week, our classroom becomes a **Detective Agency!** 🔍 We're launching **"STAAR Case Files: Mission to Mastery"** — a mystery-themed STAAR prep week where your child will work as a "detective" solving a week-long case while reviewing key skills for the STAAR test.

When: [Monday, Date] – [Friday, Date]

What your child will experience: - 🔍 A week-long mystery with daily clues revealed through completing review work - 🔍 Detective badges, case files, and a detective notebook - 🔍 Practice with STAAR-format questions framed as "evidence gathering" - 🔍 A Friday "Case Closed" celebration with certificates

How to support your detective at home: 1. **Good sleep** — Sharp detectives need rest! 8-10 hours nightly 2. **Ask about the case** — "Did you find any new clues today?" "What did you investigate?" 3. **Review together** — Your child may bring home "clue cards" (flashcards). Quick review helps! 4. **Stay positive** — "You're cracking the case. You've got this!" 5. **Healthy breakfast** — Brain fuel for the investigation

STAAR test day ([date]): Arrive rested and on time. Remind them: "You've investigated. You've gathered evidence. Now close the case!"

Thank you! 🔍

Chief Detective [Teacher Name] [Contact info]

Versión en Español

Estimadas familias,

¡La próxima semana, nuestro salón se convierte en una **Agencia de Detectives!** 🔍 Estamos lanzando **"STAAR Case Files: Misión hacia la Maestría"** — una semana de preparación para el STAAR con tema de misterio donde su hijo(a) trabajará como "detective" resolviendo un caso durante toda la semana.

Cuándo: [Lunes, fecha] – [Viernes, fecha]

Cómo apoyar a su detective en casa: 1. **Buen descanso** — 8-10 horas cada noche 2. **Pregunte sobre el caso** — "¿Encontraste nuevas pistas hoy?" 3. **Repasen juntos** — Su hijo(a) puede traer tarjetas de estudio a casa 4. **Sea positivo(a)** — "¡Estás resolviendo el caso. Tú puedes!" 5. **Desayuno saludable** — Combustible para la investigación

Detective en Jefe [Nombre del maestro(a)] [Información de contacto]